F ATOMS

is bringing the remarkable life of Marie
tional Storytelling Festival

inspired by history, culture, mythology and contemporary life.

About the production, Niranjan says Bharatanatyam has the ability to communicate stories that extend beyond its traditional repertoire. "Through its expressive language of *abhinaya*, *mudras*, rhythm and movement, Bharatanatyam has the power to communicate universal human emotions. The dance remains authentically Bharatanatyam, only the story it tells expands."

Translating the life of a scientist into a classical dance production presented creative challenges. "The classical vocabulary did not contain direct representations for concepts such as radioactivity, laboratory experiments or the Nobel Prize," explains Niranjan. "The challenge was to remain faithful to the grammar and aesthetics of Bharatanatyam while finding meaningful ways to communicate these ideas."

The work was shaped by extensive research into Curie's life and scientific achievements. "My goal was not to explain science through dance, but to express the human values that defined her life." ■

—Nikhil Sardana

The festival will be held on Aug. 15 and 16 at the NCPA, Mumbai



THE SOLO LEAP Bagchi at Aligarh Mahotsav 2026

MANAS KHUMAN

is now a formula. "Waiting for a song that showcases my talents to come to me is not an option," Bagchi explains. "I have to make my kind of songs myself."

She adds that contemporary Hindi films now rarely include female solo songs that are not item songs—especially ones a heroine can sing all by herself. "Not many films use music like *Dhurandhar*," Bagchi notes. "Despite being such a macho film, most of the audio is carried by women singers."

Among her non-film work, Bagchi recommends to fans 'Ab Ke Sawan', the ghazal 'Labon Se Baat Karo', and the self-composed 'Kaise Hum', which she created in memory of her cat Cheet (meaning 'madness' in Bengali) who passed away in 2024. ■

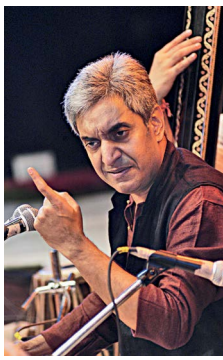
—Devarsi Ghosh



FESTIVAL ▼

Keeping Traditions Alive

The 30th edition of the **PARAMPARA SERIES** will see Hindustani classical vocal and classical dance presentations by India's leading artistes



Legendary dancing couple and Padma Bhushan recipients Raja Radha Reddy and Kaushalya Reddy established the performing arts centre Natya Tarangini in 1976 and, in 1996, they kickstarted the Parampara Series—National and International Festival of Dance and Music. "Parampara has sustained its legacy over the years because of the great masters and the young, promising and highly talented performers who have emerged in the field of Indian classical arts," they say.

The upcoming 30th edition of the festival will see a musical presentation by Shubhendra Rao, Saskia Rao-de Haas and Ishaan Rao; a Kuchipudi performance by the Raja Radha Reddy troupe; Hindustani classical vocals by Madhup Mudgal and Sawani Mudgal; Kathak by Maitreyee Pahari; and performances by Sajan Mishra and Swaransh Mishra along with Pavitra Bhat, among others.

The founders believe their work is "an *aradhana*" and that a strong classical foundation enables an artiste to pursue any genre in the future. "Over the years, we have also seen more people develop into connoisseurs and *rasikas*, with many taking an interest in learning these art forms," they add. ■

—Deepali Dhingra

The 30th Edition Parampara Series will be held from Aug. 7-9 at Kamani Auditorium, Delhi



TIMELESS LEGACY From top, Pavitra Bhat and ensemble; Madhup Mudgal; a performer from the Raja Radha Reddy Troupe